



NEXUS IQ / LEGAL + GOVERNANCE SERIES / 01

AI GOVERNANCE, TRANSPARENCY + RESPONSIBLE USE

**MASTER POLICY FOR WEBSITES, PRODUCTS, APPLICATIONS +
OPERATIONS**

Adoption-ready governance for organisations that develop, procure,
embed, provide or use artificial intelligence.

UK-FIRST / EEA-AWARE / PUBLICATION EDITION

Version 2.1 / Legal currency date: 30 August 2026

PUBLICATION STANDARD

How this document becomes operative

This is a master policy, not a fictional example. It becomes the adopting organisation's formal policy when the mandatory steps below are completed.

01

OPERATIVE ON ADOPTION

01 COMPLETE

02 APPROVE

03 PUBLISH

04 IMPLEMENT

THE ADOPTION TEST

The legal entity completes the Adoption Particulars, obtains approval from its governing body or authorised officer, publishes the completed policy and implements its controls. Blank fields mean the policy is not ready for publication.

BROAD DEPLOYMENT

The clauses cover AI used internally and AI developed, embedded or made available through a website, platform, software product, mobile application, API, assistant, model, workflow or autonomous agent.

WHAT IT BECOMES

Once completed and approved, this is the Organisation's formal AI governance policy and public transparency commitment. The Organisation remains responsible for making the controls real.

LEGAL LIMITS THAT MUST STAY VISIBLE

No single policy can guarantee compliance in every country, regulated sector or use case. This Policy does not replace a Privacy Notice, Terms of Use, Cookie Notice, Data Processing Agreement, accessibility statement, employment policy or sector-specific legal review.

Adoption particulars

Every field marked REQUIRED must be completed before publication.

Status	Particular	Organisation entry
REQUIRED	Legal entity name	[FULL LEGAL NAME]
REQUIRED	Company / charity / public-body number	[REGISTRATION NUMBER OR N/A]
REQUIRED	Registered or principal office	[FULL ADDRESS]
REQUIRED	Covered website, product, app or service	[NAMES AND URLS]
REQUIRED	Effective date	[DD MONTH YYYY]
REQUIRED	AI Governance Lead / policy owner	[ROLE AND CONTACT ROUTE]
REQUIRED	Privacy and data-protection complaints	[EMAIL OR SECURE WEB FORM]
REQUIRED	Human review / AI complaint route	[EMAIL OR SECURE WEB FORM]
REQUIRED	Privacy Notice	[PUBLIC URL]
IF APPLICABLE	Terms of Use / customer contract	[PUBLIC URL OR DOCUMENT NAME]
IF APPLICABLE	Cookie Notice	[PUBLIC URL]
REQUIRED	Approving body or authorised officer	[NAME / ROLE / COMMITTEE]
REQUIRED	Internal governing law	[ENGLAND AND WALES OR OTHER]
REQUIRED	Next formal review	[DD MONTH YYYY]

ADOPTION CONTROL RECORD

DECISION

Approval body and formal record reference

OWNER

Named lead with authority and resources

PUBLICATION

Live policy URL and effective date

REVIEW

Next review date and change trigger

NAVIGATION

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DOCUMENT ROUTE

FROM POLICY TO OPERATING CONTROL

- 01

Adopt the completed policy through a recorded authority.
- 02

Register each AI system, owner, purpose, data and dependency.
- 03

Classify risk and apply the matching evidence and approval gate.
- 04

Govern the full lifecycle and preserve an auditable decision trail.

NAVIGATION

Contents

Core policy clauses - Part II and schedules

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SCHEDULES CLOSE THE GOVERNANCE LOOP

A	B	C	D
Public-facing AI notice	Formal adoption resolution	Minimum system register	Enhanced review triggers

■ CLAUSE 1

Status, purpose and legal effect

1.1 Adoption

The legal entity identified in the Adoption Particulars is the Organisation. This Policy takes effect on the Effective Date only after approval by the Organisation's governing body or an authorised officer and completion of every mandatory publication field.

1.2 Purpose

The Policy establishes mandatory governance for the lawful, fair, secure, transparent and accountable development, procurement, integration, supply and use of AI Systems. Its purpose is to protect individuals, customers, Personnel, confidential information, intellectual property, systems and the Organisation's legitimate interests.

1.3 Public commitment and internal control

The Policy operates as both an internal governance instrument and a public statement of the Organisation's AI practices. It binds Personnel through applicable contracts, policies and lawful management instructions. It binds a supplier only to the extent incorporated into the relevant agreement.

1.4 Interpretation

'Shall' and 'must' express mandatory requirements; 'may' expresses discretion; 'including' is non-exhaustive. Headings assist navigation and do not limit the operative wording.

1.5 Applicable law

The Organisation shall identify every law, regulator rule, professional duty, product-safety requirement and contractual obligation applicable to each AI System. A stricter applicable requirement prevails over a less protective provision of this Policy.

CONTROL FOCUS

01

ADOPTION / PURPOSE / PUBLIC COMMITMENT AND INTERNAL CONTROL / INTERPRETATION

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 2

Scope and application

2.1 Systems covered

This Policy applies to machine-learning systems, generative AI, predictive or classification systems, recommendation engines, automated decision systems, foundation models, copilots, chatbots, image, audio or video generation, embedded AI features, APIs, retrieval systems, coding assistants, connected workflows and AI Agents.

2.2 Channels covered

It applies whether an AI System is built by the Organisation, commissioned, licensed, supplied by a customer, accessed through a browser or personal device, embedded in ordinary software, integrated into a website, app or product, or operated by a third party on the Organisation's behalf.

2.3 Lifecycle covered

The requirements apply to research, design, training, fine-tuning, evaluation, procurement, configuration, testing, deployment, sale, licensing, operation, monitoring, modification, suspension, decommissioning and deletion.

2.4 Persons covered

It applies to directors, officers, employees, workers, contractors, consultants, agency staff, interns and any supplier or other person authorised to use an AI System or act for the Organisation.

2.5 Territorial reach

The Organisation shall assess territorial scope before making an AI System available or monitoring, profiling or deciding about persons in another country. The relevant local and extraterritorial rules shall be recorded in the AI System Register.

2.6 No technology-label avoidance

A system remains within scope where it performs an AI function even if the vendor describes it as automation, analytics, smart search, optimisation, personalisation or another commercial label.

CONTROL FOCUS

02

SYSTEMS COVERED / CHANNELS COVERED / LIFECYCLE COVERED / PERSONS COVERED

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 3

Defined terms - Part I

3.1 AI System

A machine-based system that, for explicit or implicit objectives, infers from inputs how to generate predictions, content, recommendations, classifications, decisions or actions capable of influencing physical or virtual environments.

3.2 AI Provider

A person or organisation that develops an AI System or has one developed and places it on the market, makes it available or puts it into service under its name or trade mark. The precise statutory definition applicable in a jurisdiction prevails where different.

3.3 AI Deployer

A person or organisation using an AI System under its authority, excluding purely personal, non-professional activity. The Organisation may be both provider and deployer for different components or purposes.

3.4 AI Output

Any prediction, recommendation, decision, ranking, classification, text, code, image, audio, video, data transformation, action or other result generated or materially altered by an AI System.

3.5 AI Agent

An AI-enabled system capable of selecting or using tools, accessing data or services, communicating externally, changing records or taking actions beyond merely returning content to a user.

3.6 Approved Use

A recorded authorisation covering the exact AI System, provider, model or version where material, account type, purpose, users, data classes, integrations, actions, affected persons, jurisdictions, controls, owner and approval period.

CONTROL FOCUS

03

AI SYSTEM / AI PROVIDER / AI DEPLOYER / AI OUTPUT

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 3

Defined terms - Part II

3.7 Personal Data

Information relating to an identified or identifiable individual. Pseudonymised information remains Personal Data where re-identification is reasonably possible. Special Category Data, criminal-offence data and children's data have the meanings and protections given by applicable law.

3.8 Significant Decision

A decision that produces a legal effect or a similarly significant effect on an individual, including material decisions concerning employment, credit, insurance, housing, education, healthcare, legal rights, access to an essential service, safety or a comparable opportunity.

3.9 Solely Automated Decision

A Significant Decision made without meaningful human involvement in taking that decision. A nominal or rubber-stamp review is not meaningful human involvement.

3.10 High-Risk Use

An AI use whose failure, misuse, scale, opacity, autonomy or subject matter may materially affect health, safety, fundamental rights, equality, privacy, livelihood, access, finances, legal position or essential services, or that applicable law classifies as high-risk.

3.11 Material Change

A change to purpose, model, provider, training or reference data, data class, user population, jurisdiction, integration, permission, autonomy, output recipient, decision consequence, security posture, legal terms or known performance that may alter risk or compliance.

3.12 Vulnerable Person

A person who may face increased risk of harm or reduced ability to understand, resist or challenge an AI interaction because of age, disability, dependency, distress, financial circumstances, power imbalance or another relevant factor.

CONTROL FOCUS

03

PERSONAL DATA / SIGNIFICANT DECISION / SOLELY AUTOMATED DECISION / HIGH-RISK USE

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 4

Governance and authority

4.1 Governing body

The governing body or equivalent senior authority retains ultimate oversight of material AI risk, approves this Policy, sets risk appetite, receives material assurance and ensures adequate competence, independence and resources.

4.2 Executive accountability

A named executive shall be accountable for implementation across the Organisation and for resolving conflicts between delivery objectives and legal, ethical, safety, privacy or security requirements.

4.3 AI Governance Lead

The AI Governance Lead owns the policy framework, AI System Register, classification method, approval workflow, monitoring programme, review calendar, incident coordination and evidence of implementation.

4.4 Privacy function

The Data Protection Officer or Privacy Lead shall advise independently on controller and processor roles, lawful basis, transparency, data subject rights, automated decisions, DPIAs, international transfers, complaints and personal-data breaches.

4.5 Security function

The Security Lead shall approve the threat model, identity and access design, data flows, integration permissions, logging, testing, incident controls, vulnerability management, resilience and exit arrangements proportionate to risk.

4.6 Legal and sector review

Legal, compliance and regulated-function owners shall determine applicable consumer, employment, equality, professional, intellectual-property, product, safety, financial, health, communications and sector requirements before relevant deployment.

CONTROL FOCUS

04

GOVERNING BODY / EXECUTIVE ACCOUNTABILITY / AI GOVERNANCE LEAD / PRIVACY FUNCTION

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 4

Roles and responsibilities

4.7 Product or service owner

Each AI System shall have a named business owner with authority and budget to operate controls, accept permitted residual risk, stop the system and ensure the public description matches actual operation.

4.8 Technical owner

A named technical owner shall maintain architecture, configuration, access, testing, monitoring, change control, rollback, logs, supplier interfaces and retirement evidence.

4.9 Independent challenge

A person shall not be the sole requester, developer, tester and approver of a High-Risk Use. Review shall be sufficiently independent, technically competent and free to require remediation or refusal.

4.10 Personnel

Personnel shall use only Approved Uses, follow applicable controls, provide truthful information, verify work within their competence, preserve required records and report concerns or incidents immediately.

4.11 Escalation

Any person may pause use and escalate where legality, safety, fairness, data rights, security, accuracy, authorisation or human oversight is uncertain. Commercial urgency does not displace an escalation or stop decision.

4.12 AI literacy

The Organisation shall provide role-appropriate AI literacy and competence measures to Personnel and other persons operating AI Systems on its behalf, taking account of their knowledge, role, context and the people affected.

04

CONTROL FOCUS

PRODUCT OR SERVICE OWNER / TECHNICAL OWNER / INDEPENDENT CHALLENGE / PERSONNEL

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 5

Approval and AI System Register

5.1 Prior approval

No AI System may process non-public organisational data, affect an individual, connect to another system, communicate externally or operate as part of a product or service unless the exact use is approved and entered in the AI System Register before live use.

5.2 Use-case-specific approval

Approval attaches to the combination of system, provider, account, purpose, data, users, integrations, actions, recipients, affected persons, jurisdictions, controls and review period. Approval of a brand or subscription is insufficient.

5.3 Register

The AI Governance Lead shall maintain a complete and current register containing the minimum fields in Schedule C, the evidence supporting approval and the owner responsible for each live, suspended or retired use.

5.4 Material Change

A Material Change suspends reliance on the prior approval until the change is assessed, tested, documented and approved. Emergency security changes may be made first where necessary, provided they are recorded and reviewed promptly.

5.5 Exceptions

An exception must be time-limited, documented, approved by the accountable risk owner and relevant specialist functions, and supported by compensating controls. No exception may authorise unlawful conduct or remove a non-waivable right.

5.6 Shadow AI

Use of an unregistered system, personal account, undisclosed model, unapproved connector or unauthorised automated action for organisational work is prohibited.

CONTROL FOCUS

05

PRIOR APPROVAL / USE-CASE-SPECIFIC APPROVAL / REGISTER / MATERIAL CHANGE

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 5

Risk classification

Classification determines approval authority, evidence, testing, oversight and review frequency.

Class	Meaning	Minimum decision
PROHIBITED	Unlawful, expressly banned, deceptive or incapable of adequate control.	Do not develop, procure, deploy or use.
HIGH / CRITICAL	May materially affect safety, rights, employment, finance, access, children, vulnerable persons, sensitive data, biometrics or essential services; or has substantial autonomy or scale.	Executive risk owner plus Legal / Privacy / Security and relevant sector approval; enhanced assessment and monitoring.
MODERATE	Customer-facing, processes confidential data, materially influences people or business outcomes, or connects to controlled systems without independently taking significant action.	Business owner approval with proportionate specialist review, tests and monitoring.
LOW	Narrow internal assistance using public, synthetic or low-sensitivity information, with competent human review and no material effect on a person.	Named owner, register entry, approved account and baseline controls.

5.7 Classification duty

The product or business owner proposes a classification; the AI Governance Lead confirms it. Uncertainty is resolved in favour of the higher class until evidence supports reduction.

5.8 Residual risk

Risk may be accepted only by a person with authority over the consequence, after required safeguards and alternatives are considered. Unlawful risk cannot be accepted.

5.9 Local overlays

A legal or sector classification applies in addition to this framework. Where the EU AI Act applies, prohibited, transparency, general-purpose and high-risk categories shall be assessed separately and recorded.

■ CLAUSE 6

Lifecycle governance

Controls apply from the first business case through final deletion.

Stage	Mandatory governance outcome
1 - Need	Defined purpose, benefit, owner, affected persons, alternatives and success criteria.
2 - Assess	Legal scope, risk class, data map, DPIA or impact assessment, threat model and supplier due diligence.
3 - Design / procure	Documented requirements, contracts, permissions, human oversight, transparency, security and exit plan.
4 - Test	Representative and lawful test data, acceptance thresholds, failure tests, bias and security evaluation, documented approval.
5 - Deploy	Approved configuration, notices, access, training, logging, monitoring, support and rollback.
6 - Operate	Performance review, complaint and incident handling, vendor and legal change monitoring, periodic reapproval.
7 - Retire	Access revoked, integrations disconnected, data and copies deleted or retained lawfully, records archived and users notified where needed.

Control gate

The next lifecycle stage may begin only when its owner has recorded the evidence and approval required by the current risk class. A pilot or proof of concept is not exempt from privacy, confidentiality or security requirements.

■ **CLAUSE 7**

Lawfulness and fairness

7.1 Lawful purpose

Every AI System shall have a specific, documented and legitimate purpose. The Organisation shall identify the legal authority, lawful basis and any additional condition required for the data, decision, communication and action involved.

7.2 Necessity and proportionality

The owner shall demonstrate why the AI use is reasonably necessary and proportionate to the objective, what lower-risk alternatives were considered and why the chosen design does not intrude more than required.

7.3 Fair treatment

AI Systems shall not create unjustified adverse treatment, exploit a power imbalance, conceal a material limitation, use irrelevant proxies or produce outcomes that the Organisation could not lawfully or fairly reach without AI.

7.4 Equality and non-discrimination

The Organisation shall assess direct, indirect and combined discrimination, accessibility and disparate impact, including relevant proxy variables and the consequences of false positives and false negatives.

7.5 Evidence and explainability

The degree of explanation, traceability and evidence shall be proportionate to the consequence. The Organisation shall not deploy a system whose output cannot be understood or challenged sufficiently for its intended use.

7.6 No misleading reliance

AI Output shall not be represented as verified fact, professional judgement, independent evidence or a human decision unless that description is accurate and supported by the required review.

CONTROL FOCUS

07

**LAWFUL PURPOSE / NECESSITY AND PROPORTIONALITY / FAIR TREATMENT /
EQUALITY AND NON-DISCRIMINATION**

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 8

Website, product and app transparency

8.1 Direct interaction

A person shall be clearly informed at or before the first direct interaction with an AI System unless the AI nature is obvious from the circumstances. The notice shall use plain, accessible language and shall not be hidden in general terms.

8.2 Material role

Where AI materially generates, recommends, ranks, personalises, moderates, predicts, decides or acts, the Organisation shall explain the nature of that role, the principal limitation relevant to the user and whether a human reviews the result.

8.3 Identity of responsible entity

The interface or linked notice shall identify the Organisation, provide a functioning contact route, link the current Privacy Notice and explain how to request human review or complain where relevant.

8.4 Synthetic and altered media

AI-generated or materially altered audio, image or video shall be labelled when required by law or where omission could reasonably mislead. Machine-readable marking shall be preserved or added where legally required and technically feasible.

8.5 Public-interest content

AI-generated text published to inform the public on a matter of public interest shall receive meaningful editorial review or be disclosed as AI-generated where applicable law requires.

8.6 Accessible and timely notice

Disclosure shall be prominent, understandable on the device used, available before a consequential action, and accessible to people with disabilities. A dark pattern, vague reference to automation or inaccessible link does not satisfy this clause.

CONTROL FOCUS

08

**DIRECT INTERACTION / MATERIAL ROLE / IDENTITY OF RESPONSIBLE ENTITY /
SYNTHETIC AND ALTERED MEDIA**

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 9

Automated decisions and human review

9.1 Identification

The owner shall determine and record whether the AI System makes, recommends or materially influences a Significant Decision and whether meaningful human involvement exists in taking the final decision.

9.2 UK automated-decision safeguards

Where UK data-protection law applies to a Significant Decision based solely on automated processing, the Organisation shall use a valid lawful basis and provide the safeguards required by law, including information about the decision, a route to make representations, human intervention and a means to contest the decision.

9.3 Meaningful involvement

The human reviewer shall have relevant competence, sufficient information and time, authority to change the outcome, access to the underlying evidence and a genuine ability to identify and correct error or unfairness. Routine approval of the machine result is insufficient.

9.4 Special Category Data

A Solely Automated Decision using Special Category Data or other specially protected data shall not occur unless a specific legal condition permits it and all required safeguards and approvals are documented.

9.5 Notice and reasons

An affected person shall receive the information and explanation required for the context, including the decision's effect, the main factors or logic that can lawfully be disclosed, the role of the AI System and how to obtain review.

9.6 Stricter regimes

Where another jurisdiction or sector restricts automated decision-making more strictly, the stricter rule applies. The AI System Register shall record the applicable regime and responsible decision owner.

CONTROL FOCUS

09

IDENTIFICATION / UK AUTOMATED-DECISION SAFEGUARDS / MEANINGFUL INVOLVEMENT / SPECIAL CATEGORY DATA

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 10

Individual rights, complaints and redress

10.1 Rights by design

The Organisation shall be able to identify relevant Personal Data and support applicable rights of access, information, correction, deletion, restriction, objection, portability and rights relating to automated decisions across training, evaluation, input, output, logs, memory and connected stores.

10.2 Clear complaint route

A person shall be able to raise an AI or data-protection complaint through an electronic route that is easy to find, usable without specialist knowledge and separate from an AI-only interface where necessary.

10.3 Acknowledgement

A data-protection complaint subject to UK law shall be acknowledged within 30 days of receipt. The Organisation shall apply any shorter contractual, sector or local deadline that also applies.

10.4 Investigation and updates

The Organisation shall, without undue delay, make appropriate enquiries, preserve relevant evidence, keep the complainant informed and communicate the outcome, reasons and available escalation or regulator route.

10.5 Human escalation

A person affected by a material AI-supported outcome shall have access to a competent human route where required by law, promised by the service or necessary to prevent unfairness or material harm.

10.6 No retaliation and accessibility

A good-faith complaint, challenge or request for human review shall not itself result in adverse treatment. Reasonable adjustments and alternative communication routes shall be provided where applicable.

CONTROL FOCUS

10

RIGHTS BY DESIGN / CLEAR COMPLAINT ROUTE / ACKNOWLEDGEMENT /
INVESTIGATION AND UPDATES

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 11

Privacy, lawful basis and DPIAs

11.1 Role allocation

Before processing Personal Data, the Organisation shall document whether each participant acts as controller, joint controller, processor or subprocessor for each processing purpose. A supplier's standard label does not determine the legal role.

11.2 Lawful basis

The Organisation shall identify a lawful basis for each processing purpose and any separate condition required for Special Category Data or criminal-offence data. Consent shall not be used where it is not freely given, specific, informed and capable of withdrawal.

11.3 Data Protection Impact Assessment

A DPIA shall be completed before processing likely to create high risk to individuals, and before a High-Risk Use involving Personal Data. It shall cover necessity, proportionality, data flows, affected persons, rights, alternatives, risks, safeguards, consultation and residual risk.

11.4 Prior consultation

Where applicable law requires regulator consultation because high residual risk cannot be mitigated, the AI System shall not go live until the required process is completed and the resulting conditions are met.

11.5 Privacy information

The Privacy Notice and any just-in-time notice shall accurately describe the data, purposes, lawful bases, sources, recipients, transfers, retention, automated decision-making, individual rights and relevant use of AI.

11.6 Accountability record

The lawful-basis analysis, DPIA, controller or processor assessment, notices, consultations, approvals and material changes shall be retained with the AI System Register for the required period.

CONTROL FOCUS

11

ROLE ALLOCATION / LAWFUL BASIS / DATA PROTECTION IMPACT ASSESSMENT / PRIOR CONSULTATION

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 11

Data governance, retention and transfers

11.7 Data minimisation

Only data adequate, relevant and reasonably necessary for the Approved Use may be collected, retrieved, uploaded, inferred, retained or exposed to an AI System. Less identifiable, aggregated, synthetic or local alternatives shall be used where reasonably effective.

11.8 Data classification

Public, internal, confidential, restricted and secret data shall be handled under the Organisation's classification standard. Passwords, private keys, tokens, authentication secrets and live payment credentials shall never be placed in AI prompts, memory, logs or retrieval stores.

11.9 Training and retrieval

Personal, confidential, client or third-party data shall not be used for model training, fine-tuning, evaluation, feedback, retrieval-augmented generation or service improvement without documented authority, rights, security and privacy approval.

11.10 Retention and deletion

Inputs, outputs, prompts, logs, embeddings, feedback, memory and backups shall have documented retention rules. Deletion shall extend to suppliers and connected stores where contract and law require, subject to lawful records holds.

11.11 International transfers

The Organisation shall map the location and onward transfer of Personal Data and implement the applicable adequacy, safeguard, assessment and contractual mechanism before restricted transfers occur.

11.12 Data quality

Data used to train, test, prompt or ground an AI System shall be sufficiently accurate, relevant, representative and current for the intended consequence, with known limitations and provenance recorded.

CONTROL FOCUS

11

DATA MINIMISATION / DATA CLASSIFICATION / TRAINING AND RETRIEVAL / RETENTION AND DELETION

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 12

Children, vulnerability, equality and access

12.1 Children likely to use the service

Where an online service is likely to be accessed by children, the Organisation shall consider children's higher protection needs by design and default, including age and development, comprehension, profiling, data minimisation, safety, parental roles and the best interests of the child.

12.2 Age-appropriate information

Notices, explanations, consent mechanisms, complaint routes and controls shall be understandable to the intended age group and shall not use behavioural pressure or exploit reduced understanding.

12.3 Vulnerable Persons

The owner shall assess whether the system may exploit, manipulate, confuse, exclude or disproportionately harm a Vulnerable Person and shall implement additional protection, human support or exclusion of the use where risk cannot be controlled.

12.4 Equality assessment

High-Risk Uses and systems materially affecting people shall be tested for relevant protected groups and intersectional effects. The assessment shall examine input data, proxies, design choices, thresholds, human workflow and outcomes.

12.5 Accessibility

Customer-facing AI and the routes to obtain information, complete a transaction, refuse optional AI, request human assistance or complain shall meet applicable accessibility requirements and support reasonable adjustments.

12.6 Biometrics and emotion inference

Biometric identification, categorisation, emotion inference and similar sensitive uses require specific Legal, Privacy and Security approval and shall not be used where prohibited or where necessity and proportionality cannot be demonstrated.

CONTROL FOCUS

12

CHILDREN LIKELY TO USE THE SERVICE / AGE-APPROPRIATE INFORMATION /
VULNERABLE PERSONS / EQUALITY ASSESSMENT

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

Security, resilience and access control

13.1 Secure by design

Security requirements shall be defined before procurement or development and maintained throughout the lifecycle. The threat model shall cover ordinary cyber threats and AI-specific threats including prompt injection, data poisoning, model or data extraction, unsafe tool use and output manipulation.

13.2 Least privilege

Users, models, agents, service accounts, connectors and tools shall have only the minimum data, permissions, actions, duration and environment necessary for the Approved Use. Privileged access shall be separately controlled and reviewed.

13.3 Identity and secrets

Organisational accounts, strong authentication, approved secrets management and role-based access shall be used. Credentials shall not be embedded in prompts, source files, training data or unrestricted logs.

13.4 Untrusted content

Content from websites, email, documents, retrieval sources, user uploads and tool output shall be treated as potentially malicious. Instructions within such content shall not override system, security or approval controls.

13.5 Segregation and isolation

Development, testing and production shall be separated proportionate to risk. Client, tenant and sensitive datasets, vector stores, memory, logs and tool permissions shall be segregated to prevent unauthorised cross-access.

13.6 Resilience

The Organisation shall maintain backups, rollback, dependency management, vulnerability remediation, availability measures, fail-safe behaviour and a tested recovery plan proportionate to the consequence of failure.

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CONTROL FOCUS

SECURE BY DESIGN / LEAST PRIVILEGE / IDENTITY AND SECRETS / UNTRUSTED CONTENT

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 14

Agentic AI and connected systems

14.1 Specific approval

An AI Agent shall not access live systems or external communication channels until its exact tools, data, permissions, actions, limits, review points, logs and stop controls are approved.

14.2 Allowlisted capability

The Agent may use only allowlisted domains, tools, recipients, repositories, file locations, commands, record types and transaction classes necessary for its approved objective.

14.3 Human confirmation

A competent human shall confirm before an Agent makes or commits a payment, enters or varies a contract, publishes externally, sends a material communication, deletes or overwrites data, changes access, deploys code or takes another consequential or irreversible action.

14.4 Bounded operation

Spend, rate, time, volume, retry, recursion, data-access and action limits shall prevent uncontrolled loops, cost, propagation or escalation. Failure shall place the system in a safe state.

14.5 Stop and recover

A named operator shall be able to pause the Agent immediately, revoke credentials, isolate integrations, inspect actions and restore an authorised state. These controls shall be tested before live operation.

14.6 Traceability

Instructions, retrieved context, tool calls, approvals, actions, failures, overrides and resulting changes shall be logged to a level that supports investigation without exposing unnecessary Personal Data or secrets.

14.7 Testing

Agents shall first operate in an isolated environment with synthetic or authorised test data, adversarial inputs and failure scenarios. Live authority shall expand only through documented, risk-based approval.

CONTROL FOCUS

14

SPECIFIC APPROVAL / ALLOWLISTED CAPABILITY / HUMAN CONFIRMATION / BOUNDED OPERATION

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 15

Third parties and the AI supply chain

15.1 Due diligence

Before contracting, the Organisation shall assess the provider, model, data use, retention, location, subprocessors, security, service controls, performance evidence, rights allocation, complaints support, incident history, change process, continuity and exit capability.

15.2 Contract controls

Contracts shall address purpose, instructions, confidentiality, data protection, security, audit evidence, subprocessors, transfers, service levels, incident notice, intellectual property, training or improvement use, deletion, assistance, change notification, suspension and exit proportionate to risk.

15.3 Account configuration

The Organisation shall use an approved organisational plan and configure training, history, memory, sharing, retention, connectors, model access, administration and logs according to the Approved Use. Subscription price alone is not evidence of compliance.

15.4 Supply-chain responsibility

Outsourcing or using an API does not transfer the Organisation's responsibility for its purpose, data, customer promises, decisions, configuration, monitoring or compliance.

15.5 Provider change

Material changes to models, terms, subprocessors, locations, data use, capabilities, safety controls or ownership shall be assessed through change control before continued reliance.

15.6 Exit and portability

The owner shall maintain a feasible process to export required records, disconnect integrations, revoke access, delete retained data, replace critical functionality and evidence completion without unreasonable dependency on the provider.

CONTROL FOCUS

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DUE DILIGENCE / CONTRACT CONTROLS / ACCOUNT CONFIGURATION / SUPPLY-CHAIN RESPONSIBILITY

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 16

Testing, accuracy and robustness

16.1 Acceptance criteria

Before release, the owner shall define measurable acceptance criteria linked to intended purpose, affected persons, risk class and the consequence of error, including thresholds that require refusal, fallback or human escalation.

16.2 Representative evaluation

Testing shall use lawfully obtained, sufficiently representative and appropriately segmented data and scenarios, including edge cases, accessibility needs, adversarial inputs, foreseeable misuse and conditions outside normal operation.

16.3 Accuracy and calibration

The Organisation shall evaluate factual accuracy, statistical performance, confidence or calibration where relevant, false positive and false negative rates, consistency, completeness and known limitations. Metrics shall not conceal material subgroup harm.

16.4 Human verification

Material AI Output shall be reviewed by a person competent in the subject and authorised for the consequence. Facts, sources, dates, quotations, calculations, legal conclusions, safety advice and regulated claims shall be independently checked.

16.5 Software assurance

AI-assisted code shall be understood, peer reviewed, tested and scanned through the applicable secure development lifecycle. Packages, licences, secrets, vulnerabilities, provenance and deployment controls shall be verified before release.

16.6 Robustness and abuse

Testing shall address prompt injection, data leakage, harmful content, model evasion, tool misuse, manipulation, unavailable dependencies, drift and recovery. A known critical failure mode shall be mitigated or the system withheld.

16.7 Evidence

Test plans, data provenance, versions, results, failures, mitigations, residual risk, approvers and release decisions shall be retained and linked to the AI System Register.

CONTROL FOCUS

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ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA / REPRESENTATIVE EVALUATION / ACCURACY AND CALIBRATION / HUMAN VERIFICATION

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 17

Monitoring, records and audit

17.1 Continuous monitoring

Live systems shall be monitored proportionate to risk for performance, safety, security, fairness, data leakage, misuse, complaint patterns, cost, latency, failure, model or data drift and divergence from the Approved Use.

17.2 Alert and action thresholds

The owner shall define thresholds for review, human takeover, output restriction, rollback, suspension and incident escalation. Alerts shall reach a person with authority to act.

17.3 Logging

Logs shall capture the events necessary to demonstrate and investigate operation, decisions, approvals, changes and incidents. Logs shall be accurate, access-controlled, tamper-resistant, time-synchronised where material and limited to necessary data.

17.4 Decision records

For material outcomes, the Organisation shall retain the model or system version, material input or evidence, output, human reviewer, final decision, reasons, notice and challenge outcome to the extent lawful and proportionate.

17.5 Audit

The AI Governance Lead, Internal Audit or authorised independent reviewer may inspect systems, suppliers, records, configurations, samples and controls. Owners shall remediate findings within an approved timeframe.

17.6 Retention

Governance records shall be retained for the longer of the applicable legal, contractual, limitation, audit and risk period, balanced against data-minimisation and storage-limitation duties.

17.7 Management information

Senior management shall receive proportionate information on registered systems, risk classes, incidents, complaints, overdue reviews, exceptions, supplier changes, performance and remediation.

CONTROL FOCUS

17

CONTINUOUS MONITORING / ALERT AND ACTION THRESHOLDS / LOGGING / DECISION RECORDS

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 18

AI incidents and data breaches

18.1 Incident definition

An AI incident includes unauthorised access or use, Personal Data or confidential-data exposure, harmful or discriminatory output, unsafe action, incorrect Significant Decision, deceptive content, material security weakness, loss of control, unexplained drift, breach of approval or legal non-compliance.

18.2 Immediate reporting

Personnel and suppliers shall report a suspected incident immediately through the approved route and shall not wait for certainty or attempt to conceal, alter or delete evidence.

18.3 Containment

The response owner may pause the system, disable outputs or actions, isolate integrations, revoke credentials, preserve evidence, notify internal functions and apply emergency controls.

18.4 Assessment

The incident team shall document the timeline, systems, data, people, jurisdictions, recipients, actions, consequences, containment, legal duties and residual risk, and shall maintain a decision log.

18.5 Personal-data breach

The Privacy Lead shall assess notification to the relevant authority and affected individuals. Where UK GDPR applies, a notifiable breach shall be reported without undue delay and, where feasible, within 72 hours after awareness.

18.6 Other notifications

The Organisation shall meet applicable customer, insurer, sector, product-safety, cyber, law-enforcement and AI-regulator notification duties and contractual deadlines.

18.7 Remediation

Recovery shall include correction of affected records or decisions, appropriate communication, root-cause analysis, control and training updates, supplier action, re-testing and formal authority before restart.

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CONTROL FOCUS

INCIDENT DEFINITION / IMMEDIATE REPORTING / CONTAINMENT / ASSESSMENT

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ **CLAUSE 19**

Intellectual property, confidentiality and provenance

19.1 Authority for inputs

Data or content shall be uploaded, copied, scraped, used for training or otherwise processed only where the Organisation has the necessary copyright, database, contractual, confidentiality, privacy and other authority. Public availability alone is not permission.

19.2 Output review

A provider's terms cannot guarantee that an AI Output is unique, protectable or free from third-party rights. Material output shall be reviewed for copied expression, code, brands, designs, music, confidential information, likeness, voice and other protected interests.

19.3 Human contribution

Where ownership or protection is commercially important, the Organisation shall record substantive human authorship, selection, arrangement, judgement, editing and source material and shall not make unsupported claims of exclusive rights.

19.4 Software and licences

Generated code and dependencies shall be checked for source, package identity, licence obligations, notices, attribution, vulnerability, malicious content and incompatibility with the intended distribution model.

19.5 Confidentiality

Confidential, privileged, trade-secret and client material may be processed only within the Approved Use and authorised environment. Use of an AI service shall not be treated as permission to disclose or as a waiver of duty or privilege.

19.6 Provenance records

The Organisation shall preserve proportionate records of important sources, licences, consent, model and tool, human contribution, review and publication decision for material commercial assets.

CONTROL FOCUS

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AUTHORITY FOR INPUTS / OUTPUT REVIEW / HUMAN CONTRIBUTION / SOFTWARE AND LICENCES

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 20

Content, marketing and consumer communications

20.1 Truth and professional diligence

AI-assisted commercial practices, sales material, pricing, product descriptions, comparisons, endorsements and customer communications shall be accurate, fair, substantiated and presented with the professional diligence required by applicable consumer law.

20.2 Material information

AI shall not be used to omit, obscure, fabricate or distort information likely to affect a consumer's transactional decision, including price components, limitations, risks, availability, evidence, sponsorship or the identity of the trader.

20.3 Reviews and endorsements

The Organisation shall not create, commission, publish or manipulate fake reviews, testimonials, engagement, identities or endorsements. Any material commercial relationship or synthetic representation shall be disclosed as required.

20.4 Synthetic persons and media

A realistic synthetic voice, image, video, persona or digital replica shall not be used to imply the identity, words, conduct, consent or endorsement of a real person without lawful authority and clear disclosure where a person could be misled.

20.5 Editorial accountability

A named human remains accountable for externally published content. AI assistance does not reduce the Organisation's responsibility for accuracy, rights, accessibility, legality, brand and correction.

20.6 Correction

Materially false or misleading AI-assisted content shall be corrected or withdrawn promptly, affected users shall be informed where necessary, and the cause and control failure shall be recorded.

CONTROL FOCUS

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TRUTH AND PROFESSIONAL DILIGENCE / MATERIAL INFORMATION / REVIEWS AND ENDORSEMENTS / SYNTHETIC PERSONS AND MEDIA

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 21

Prohibited practices

21.1 Unlawful or harmful use

No person may use an AI System to commit, facilitate or conceal unlawful conduct, fraud, harassment, discrimination, exploitation, unsafe activity, malicious cyber activity, infringement, impersonation or a breach of confidentiality, privacy or professional duty.

21.2 Manipulation and exploitation

AI shall not use deceptive, subliminal or manipulative techniques, or exploit age, disability, dependency, distress or another vulnerability, where this materially impairs informed choice or causes or is likely to cause significant harm.

21.3 Social scoring and protected inference

AI shall not conduct unlawful social scoring, infer or categorise protected or highly sensitive characteristics without specific lawful authority, or use irrelevant personal traits to determine access, treatment or opportunity.

21.4 Biometric and emotion practices

Untargeted facial-image scraping, prohibited biometric categorisation, prohibited real-time remote biometric identification and prohibited emotion recognition shall not be undertaken. Any lawful exception requires documented specialist approval.

21.5 Deception and fabricated evidence

AI shall not fabricate evidence, citations, records, qualifications, identities, consent, reviews, transactions or events, or conceal material AI alteration where a person could reasonably be misled.

21.6 Control bypass

No person may bypass safety controls, approval, monitoring, access restrictions, licences, security testing, human review or a lawful request to stop, or connect an unapproved tool or account.

21.7 Uncontrolled decisions and actions

A Solely Automated Decision or autonomous consequential action shall not occur without the lawful basis, safeguards, authority, monitoring and human route required by this Policy and applicable law.

21.8 Absolute legal prohibition

A use prohibited by applicable law remains prohibited regardless of consent, contract, business benefit, technical availability or risk acceptance.

CONTROL FOCUS

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UNLAWFUL OR HARMFUL USE / MANIPULATION AND EXPLOITATION / SOCIAL SCORING AND PROTECTED INFERENCE / BIOMETRIC AND EMOTION PRACTICES

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 22

Workforce use, training and enforcement

22.1 Approved work use

Personnel shall use AI for work only through an Approved Use and approved organisational account. Personal subscriptions and consumer accounts shall not process organisational or client information unless explicitly approved.

22.2 Responsibility for work

The individual submitting or approving AI-assisted work remains responsible for its accuracy, evidence, confidentiality, rights, professional standard and lawful release. AI Output shall not be presented as independently verified work.

22.3 Employment decisions

Recruitment, performance, monitoring, scheduling, discipline, dismissal, pay, promotion and similar workforce uses require enhanced Legal, Privacy and equality review, employee transparency and meaningful human authority.

22.4 Training and acknowledgement

Access shall be conditional on role-appropriate training and acknowledgement covering approved scope, data, security, verification, bias, transparency, intellectual property, incident reporting and relevant human oversight.

22.5 Monitoring Personnel

AI-enabled workplace monitoring shall be necessary, proportionate, transparent and lawfully authorised, with a documented assessment of less intrusive alternatives and the effect on dignity, equality and trust.

22.6 Speak-up protection

Good-faith reporting of an AI risk, error, incident or pressure to bypass controls shall be handled under the applicable whistleblowing or speak-up process and shall not result in retaliation.

22.7 Enforcement

A breach may result in retraining, restriction or removal of access, remediation, disciplinary action, contract remedies or legal action, applied consistently, proportionately and under applicable procedures.

CONTROL FOCUS

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APPROVED WORK USE / RESPONSIBILITY FOR WORK / EMPLOYMENT DECISIONS /
TRAINING AND ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 23

Change, suspension, review and retirement

23.1 Immediate suspension

The AI Governance Lead, Security Lead, Privacy Lead, accountable executive or system owner may suspend an AI System where continued operation may be unlawful, unsafe, misleading, insecure, outside approval or materially harmful.

23.2 Material Change review

A Material Change requires reclassification and proportionate re-performance of legal, privacy, security, supplier, testing, transparency and approval controls before continued live use.

23.3 Periodic review

Every live system shall be reviewed at least annually. A High-Risk Use shall be reviewed more frequently according to its risk plan, and immediately after a material incident, complaint trend, control failure or relevant legal change.

23.4 Policy review

This Policy shall be reviewed at least annually and sooner where law, regulator guidance, technology, organisational use or risk materially changes. The legal currency date shall be updated only after current-source review.

23.5 Retirement

Retirement shall include user and customer communication where required, access revocation, connector removal, data and copy disposition, record preservation, supplier confirmation, continuity arrangements and closure of outstanding incidents or complaints.

23.6 Version control

The Organisation shall publish the current version, retain prior versions and approval evidence, record material changes and state the effective date. A change shall not retrospectively reduce accrued statutory or contractual rights.

CONTROL FOCUS

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IMMEDIATE SUSPENSION / MATERIAL CHANGE REVIEW / PERIODIC REVIEW / POLICY REVIEW

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

■ CLAUSE 24

General legal provisions

24.1 Hierarchy

Mandatory law and regulator requirements prevail. This Policy shall be read with the applicable Privacy Notice, Terms of Use, Data Processing Agreement, employment documents, information-security policies, supplier contracts and sector controls. The stricter protection applies where obligations can lawfully operate together.

24.2 Contractual status

Publication of this Policy does not by itself amend a separate contract or create a contractual warranty. A clause becomes contractual only where expressly incorporated or where applicable law gives it that effect.

24.3 Non-excludable rights

Nothing in this Policy excludes, limits or waives liability, consumer protection, data-protection rights, employment rights or another duty that cannot lawfully be excluded, limited or waived.

24.4 Severability

If a provision is held invalid or unenforceable, it shall be read down to the minimum extent necessary and the remaining provisions continue in effect, provided the Policy's essential protective purpose is preserved.

24.5 No waiver

Failure or delay in enforcing a provision does not waive that provision or any later breach. An approval or exception applies only to its recorded scope and period.

24.6 Delegated authority

References to approval mean approval by a person with actual authority under the Organisation's governance. Self-approval or approval by a system, vendor or unauthorised person is ineffective.

24.7 Governing law

For internal administration, this Policy is governed by the law stated in the Adoption Particulars, subject to mandatory law in any other applicable jurisdiction. It does not change the governing law of a separate contract unless expressly incorporated.

24.8 Accessibility and language

The Organisation shall publish the Policy in an accessible format and provide an appropriate language or alternative format where required for the intended audience.

CONTROL FOCUS

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HIERARCHY / CONTRACTUAL STATUS / NON-EXCLUDABLE RIGHTS / SEVERABILITY

NEXUS IQ / GOVERNANCE STANDARD

SCHEDULES A-B

Publication and adoption schedules

The website block below is ready to publish after every bracketed field is completed.

SCHEDULE A - PUBLIC AI NOTICE

[LEGAL ENTITY NAME] uses artificial intelligence in [NAME THE WEBSITE, PRODUCT, APP OR SERVICE AND THE MATERIAL FUNCTIONS]. Where you interact directly with AI, we identify that interaction at or before it begins. AI may generate, recommend, rank, personalise, moderate, predict or otherwise assist with parts of the service. [STATE WHETHER AND WHERE A HUMAN REVIEWS MATERIAL OUTPUTS OR DECISIONS]. We do not use solely automated processing to make a legal or similarly significant decision about you unless we have a valid legal basis, provide the information and safeguards required by law, and give you a route to make representations, obtain human intervention and contest the decision. Our Privacy Notice explains how we use personal data: [PRIVACY NOTICE URL]. To request human review or raise an AI concern, use [AI CONTACT]. To make a data-protection complaint, use [PRIVACY COMPLAINT ROUTE].

SCHEDULE B - ADOPTION RESOLUTION

The governing body or authorised officer of [LEGAL ENTITY NAME] approves and adopts the Nexus IQ AI Governance, Transparency and Responsible Use Policy, version [VERSION], effective [DATE], for [COVERED SERVICES AND OPERATIONS]. The AI Governance Lead is authorised to maintain the AI System Register, issue controlled procedures and suspend use where required by the Policy. Approval record: [BODY / OFFICER], [DATE], [MINUTE OR RECORD REFERENCE].

Publication check: no brackets remain; links work; contacts are monitored; approval evidence is retained; related notices are consistent.

SCHEDULES C-D

Register fields and mandatory risk triggers

SCHEDULE C - MINIMUM AI SYSTEM REGISTER

Identity and ownership	System, provider, model/version, account, owner, technical owner, users, status and dates.
Purpose and scope	Approved purpose, affected persons, outputs, decisions, recipients, jurisdictions and success criteria.
Data and rights	Sources, classes, lawful basis, roles, retention, transfers, training use, DPIA, notices and rights route.
Technology and access	Architecture, integrations, tools, permissions, actions, memory, logs, security and stop controls.
Assurance	Risk class, tests, thresholds, limitations, human oversight, approvals, monitoring and complaints.
Change and exit	Material changes, incidents, exceptions, reviews, suspension, deletion and retirement evidence.

SCHEDULE D - ENHANCED REVIEW TRIGGERS

DPIA / LEGAL / SECURITY GATE

Profiling, ranking or evaluation of people; Significant Decisions; employment, credit, insurance, education, housing, healthcare, legal, safety or essential-service outcomes; children or Vulnerable Persons; biometrics, emotion or identity analysis; Special Category or criminal-offence data; large-scale or systematic monitoring; scraping, matching or inference people would not reasonably expect; high autonomy or irreversible action; public-interest synthetic content; material cross-border processing; safety-critical integration; or any use designated high-risk by applicable law.

A trigger does not automatically prohibit the use. It requires the applicable enhanced assessment and approval before live processing; a legal prohibition remains absolute.

REGISTER EVIDENCE STANDARD

DECISION TRAIL

Purpose, risk, authority and approval

TECHNICAL TRAIL

Version, data, tests, access and logs

RIGHTS TRAIL

Notice, review, complaints and outcomes

EXIT TRAIL

Suspension, deletion and retirement proof

LEGAL CURRENCY

Regulatory sources and update position

Primary-source reference date: 30 August 2026. Verify current law and sector guidance before adoption or material change.

UK ICO	AI and data protection guidance	ico.org.uk - AI guidance
UK ICO	Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 changes	ico.org.uk - DUAA 2025
UK ICO	Data-protection complaints guidance	ico.org.uk - complaints
UK ICO	Personal-data breach guidance	ico.org.uk - breach reporting
UK GOV	AI regulatory principles for regulators	gov.uk - AI principles
UK CMA	Unfair commercial practices guidance	gov.uk - CMA207
UK NCSC	Guidelines for secure AI system development	ncsc.gov.uk - secure AI
EU	AI Act framework and application timetable	ec.europa.eu - AI Act
EU	Article 50 transparency guidance	ec.europa.eu - Article 50

Currency note

As at the reference date, all UK data-protection provisions of the Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 were in force; EU AI Act transparency duties applied from 2 August 2026, with later application dates for specified high-risk rules. ICO AI guidance remained subject to updates following the UK reforms. The adopting organisation must verify current sources and its own territorial, sector and product scope.

SOURCE VERIFICATION RECORD

CHECKED BY	CHECK DATE	SCOPE	OUTCOME
[NAME AND ROLE]	[DD MONTH YYYY]	[COUNTRY / SECTOR / PRODUCT]	[CHANGES OR NONE]



NEXUS IQ / LEGAL + GOVERNANCE SERIES

GOVERN AI. EARN TRUST.

A strong policy is the public promise. Evidence, ownership and operational control are what make it credible.

NEXUS IQ SYSTEMS

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SYSTEMS THAT SCALE / INTELLIGENCE THAT EVOLVES